The traditional method involves slow-simmering a whole chicken, but this version takes less time and effort. To make a more substantial meal, add a few boiled potatoes.

cock-a-leekie soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 1¼ HRS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

1lb (450g) chicken breasts and thighs, skinned
2 bay leaves
1 quart (1 liter) chicken or vegetable stock
2oz (60g) long-grain rice
2 leeks, thinly sliced
2 carrots, grated
pinch of ground cloves
1 tsp sea salt
1 tbsp chopped fresh parsley

1 Place the chicken in a large pan with the bay leaves and pour in the stock. Bring to a boil, then reduce the heat, cover the pan, and simmer for 30 minutes.

2 Skim the surface of the soup and discard any foam that has formed. Add the rice, leeks, carrots, cloves, and salt. Bring back to a boil, reduce the heat, cover the pan, and simmer for another 30 minutes.

3 Remove the bay leaves and discard. Lift out the chicken, remove the meat from the bones, then return the meat to the soup. Ladle the soup into a warm tureen or divide between individual serving bowls, and serve hot, garnished with parsley.



CHICKEN
Free-range chickens are afforded space to move around in and access to the open air, making them healthier than caged birds, and this is reflected in the taste. Choose a bird with a firm, plump breast and tight skin.